

Notification system: what changed

Six edits to `backend-requirements.md` , §3.10 / §14 / §19 / §22 / §23 — reflecting the frontend work shipped this session. Backend status is unchanged: still 🚧 not built.

📄 `backend-requirements.md` · 6 hunks · project: volunteer-organization

BACKEND ENDPOINT

🚧 Still not built

NEW REQUIREMENT

+1 endpoint (read-all)

FRONTEND

✅ Shipped this session

Patch 01 Notification entity — field list

§3.10 · lines 143–144

Replaces a guessed field list with the actual contract: **read_at** instead of a boolean, and **type** renamed to **notificationType** to avoid colliding with Laravel's own notification class-name column.

```
@@ backend-requirements.md:143,2 +143,10 @@
```

```
- ### 3.10 Notification - 🚧 not built at all
- `id, type, title, description, href, seen (boolean)`.
+ ### 3.10 Notification - 🚧 backend not built yet; frontend contract finalized
+ `id, notificationType, title, description, href, read_at (timestamp|null)`.
+
+ Recommended storage: Laravel's built-in `database` notification channel (`Notifiable`
+ trait) instead of a bespoke table – gives `id` (uuid), `type` (PHP class name),
+ `notifiable_type/id, data (json), read_at, created_at` for free. The frontend-relevant
+ fields (`notificationType`, `title`, `description`, `href`) must be nested inside `data`
+ – a bare `type` column collides with Laravel's own class-name column. `seen (boolean)`
+ is superseded by `read_at`: `null` = unread, timestamp = read. Full schema/endpoint spec:
+ `docs/notifications-backend-integration.md` (frontend repo).
```

Patch 02 Entity-relationship summary — missing entity

§3 diagram · line 155

The relationship diagram never listed Notification at all. It's polymorphic — belongs to a User or an Organization — matching Laravel's **notifiable** convention.

```
@@ backend-requirements.md:155,1 +155,2 @@
```

```
Volunteer —N:N— Achievement (platform-wide unlock state)
```

```
+ User —1:N— Notification (polymorphic notifiable: User or Organization)
```

Status is **unchanged** — still not built backend-side. What changed: the frontend is now feature-complete, and the real spec lives in one dedicated doc instead of a two-line summary.

@@ backend-requirements.md:377,9 +377,19 @@

```
- ## 14. Notifications
-
- 🚧 **No real endpoint exists yet** ("approved by backend team but not built" per code
- comment, `src/services/notifications.js:1-13`). Intended shape once built: `GET
- /notifications → [{id, type, title, description, href, seen}]`.
-
- Types the frontend already renders (derived client-side today): `achievement`, `hours`,
- `status-accepted`, `status-rejected`, `opportunity-reminder`, `org-verified`,
- `org-rejected`, `applicant-withdrawn`.
-
- ⚠️ **Gap**: "seen/read" state is currently tracked **entirely client-side** via 5 separate
- localStorage maps, with no server representation at all. If/when this endpoint is
- built, a `PATCH /notifications/{id}/read`-style mechanism will be needed, replacing the
- localStorage trackers.
-
- `useRecentUpdates` polls this data source **every 5 seconds** for authenticated
- volunteers and for organizations that have an `organizationId`
- (`src/hooks/useRecentUpdates.js:23,31-34`) — whatever endpoint backs this must be cheap
- enough to poll per active user.
+ ## 14. Notifications
+
+ 🚧 **No real endpoint exists yet on the backend** — unchanged. What changed since the
+ last pass: the frontend implementation is now feature-complete, and the intended API
+ contract is fully specified in a dedicated document —
+ `docs/notifications-backend-integration.md` (frontend repo) — which supersedes the
+ two-line summary previously here.
+
+ Frontend additions (mock-only, ready to swap to real API):
+ - A dedicated `/notifications` page (`src/pages/notifications.jsx`), separate from the
+   navbar bell dropdown — full list, type filter tabs, "mark all as read".
+ - "Mark as read" is now an **explicit user action** (`onDismiss` per item) instead of an
+   incidental side effect of visiting an unrelated page. Real-mode wiring already
+   stubbed: `onDismiss: () ⇒ apiClient.post(`/notifications/{id}/read`)`.
+ - Confirmed the exact 8 types the backend must be able to produce: `achievement`,
+   `hours`, `status-accepted`, `status-rejected`, `opportunity-reminder`,
+   `org-verified`, `org-rejected`, `applicant-withdrawn` — event-to-trigger mapping
+   for each is in the new doc.
+
+ ⚠️ **Gap (unchanged)**: "seen/read" state is still tracked **entirely client-side** via
+ 5 separate localStorage maps. Two endpoints are required to retire them: `POST
+ /notifications/{id}/read` **and** `POST /notifications/read-all` (the second is a new
+ requirement not previously listed here).
+
+ `useRecentUpdates` still polls **every 5 seconds** — unchanged. The new
+ `/notifications` page reuses the same hook/poll, so no additional load pattern was
```

+ introduced.

Patch 04 Endpoint catalog — Misc table

§19 · Line 536

One assumed endpoint becomes three. Bulk **mark-all-as-read** wasn't in the original guess but is needed by the new "Mark all as read" action on the /notifications page.

@@ backend-requirements.md:536,1 +536,3 @@

```
- | `GET /notifications` | - | `{id, type, title, description, href, seen}` | 🚧 not built |
+ | `GET /notifications` | - | Paginated, `created_at` desc; item: `{id, data:
  {notificationType,title,description,href}, read_at, created_at}` | 🚧 not built |
+ | `POST /notifications/{id}/read` | - | marks one notification as read | 🆕 new requirement |
+ | `POST /notifications/read-all` | - | marks all of the current user's notifications as read | 🆕
  new requirement |
```

Patch 05 Backend team checklist — notifications bullet

§22 · Line 601

Checklist item now matches the three endpoints actually required, and points to the detailed spec instead of leaving "a mark-as-read mechanism" vague.

@@ backend-requirements.md:601,1 +601,3 @@

```
- - [ ] Build `GET /notifications` (+ a mark-as-read mechanism) - currently entirely client-
  side/localStorage.
+ - [ ] Build `GET /notifications`, `POST /notifications/{id}/read`, `POST /notifications/read-all`
  -
+   currently entirely client-side/localStorage. Full schema + event-trigger mapping per type
+   now specified in `docs/notifications-backend-integration.md`.
```

Impact statement widened: it's not just the bell dropdown anymore — a full dedicated page now depends on this endpoint too.

```
@@ backend-requirements.md:631,1 +631,3 @@
```

```
- | No notifications endpoint | Notification bell is fully simulated client-side |  
  `src/services/notifications.js:1-13` |  
+ | No notifications endpoint | Notification bell **and** the new dedicated `/notifications` page  
  are  
+ fully simulated client-side; frontend is otherwise feature-complete and ready to swap to real data  
+ via a single-file change (`services/notifications.js`) | `src/services/notifications.js`,  
+ `docs/notifications-backend-integration.md` |
```

For the backend team — three things to build

- ☐ `notifications` table via Laravel's native `database` channel — `data` json holds `notificationType`, `title`, `description`, `href`; use `read_at`, not a boolean.
- ☐ `GET /notifications` — paginated, sorted `created_at` desc.
- ☐ `POST /notifications/{id}/read` and `POST /notifications/read-all` — the second one is new, wasn't in the original doc.

Full schema, endpoint contracts, and per-type trigger mapping: `docs/notifications-backend-integration.md` in the frontend repo.